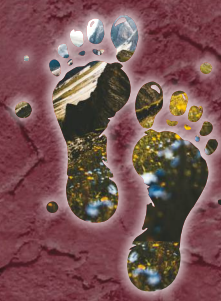




Shravasti



Shravasti (ancient Savatthi) was the capital city of the kingdom of Kosala. It was a beautiful city in the Gangetic plains with vast amounts of agriculture and diversity. Lord Buddha spent 25 rainy seasons (vassavasa) here. Thus, Shravasti is the place where Lord Buddha lived the longest amount of time and most of Lord Buddha's Teachings had been taught here. At Shravasti, visitors can explore the legendary site of the Twin Miracle, Jetavana Monastery where Lord Gautama Buddha is believed to have amazed onlookers by emitting fire from the upper part of his body and water from the lower part at the same time, while creating multiple images of himself teaching in unison, an awe-inspiring display that drew many to embrace his path.

Here, once the feared bandit Angulimala, known for wearing a garland of his victims' fingers, encountered Lord Buddha near Jetavana. Despite Angulimala's attempts to attack, Lord Buddha's calm presence stopped him in his tracks. Moved by compassion and wisdom, he renounced violence, became a monk, and eventually attained enlightenment—transforming from a ruthless killer into a symbol of redemption and peace. Of particular importance, it is the place where millions of humans, devas and brahmas attained enlightenment, especially during Lord Buddha's time.

"And the rulers and citizens of many countries vied with one another in making offerings at Jetavana Vihara, hanging silk permants and canopies, scattering flowers and lighting lamps, which burnt day and night without ever being extinguished."
- Fa Hien, 5th century A.D.



A sandstone panel from Bharhut in central India, showing the purchase of the Jetavana Vihara in Shravasti.



Maheth

Located on the banks of the river Archiravati (Rapti), the city of Shravasti had a high earthen rampart with a brick wall running along a circuit of 5.23 km. and pierced by several gates distinguished by high bastions. Four main gates are known as Imli Darwaza, Rajgarh Darwaza, Naushahra Darwaza and Kand bhari Darwaza situated respectively at the south-west, north-west, north-east and south-east corners. The remains within the city area include Buddhist, Brahmanical and Jain structures and a few medieval tombs. Timings: 6:00 AM – 6:00 PM (daily, sunrise to sunset)



Shobhanath Temple

This temple is dedicated to the 3rd Tirthankar, Lord Sambhavnath, who was born here. The 8th Tirthankar, Lord Chandraprabhu, is also said to have meditated here. The birthday of Lord Sambhavnath is celebrated here in a big way (Kartik-Oct./Nov.). Two modern Jain temples of Shetambar and Digambar sects on Balrampur road, also grace Shravasti. Nearby stands the **Digambar Sambhavnath Tirth Kshetra**, featuring an elegant white idol of Sambhavnath in a lotus posture, along with 24 Tirthankara figures displayed around it.



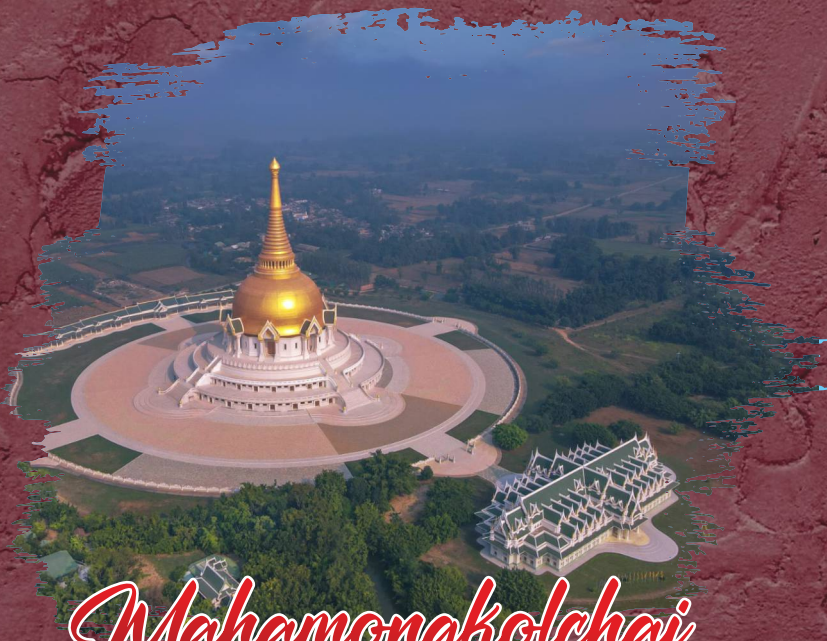
Saheth

Saheth is a serene archaeological site near Maheth, known for the historic Jetavana Monastery where Lord Buddha spent many rainy seasons. Spread over 32 acres, it features ancient stupas, shrines, and monasteries, reflecting Kushana and Gupta-era architecture. Relics dating back to the 3rd century B.C. to 12th century A.D. have been unearthed here, including one of the earliest stupas believed to house Lord Buddha's relics. Don't miss the spiritual ambiance and deep historical connect to Emperor Ashoka and the Chinese traveller Huien Tsang. Timings: 6:00 AM – 6:00 PM (daily, sunrise to sunset)



Pakki Kuti

Pakki Kuti, also known as Angulimal Gufa is believed to be the home of Angulimala's parents—a key figure in Buddhist lore. Once a feared killer misled into violence, Angulimala had a dramatic transformation after encountering Lord Buddha, who guided him to renounce his path and become a monk. This powerful story of redemption adds spiritual depth to the site. The structure has seen many changes over the centuries, but its legacy remains deeply moving for visitors.



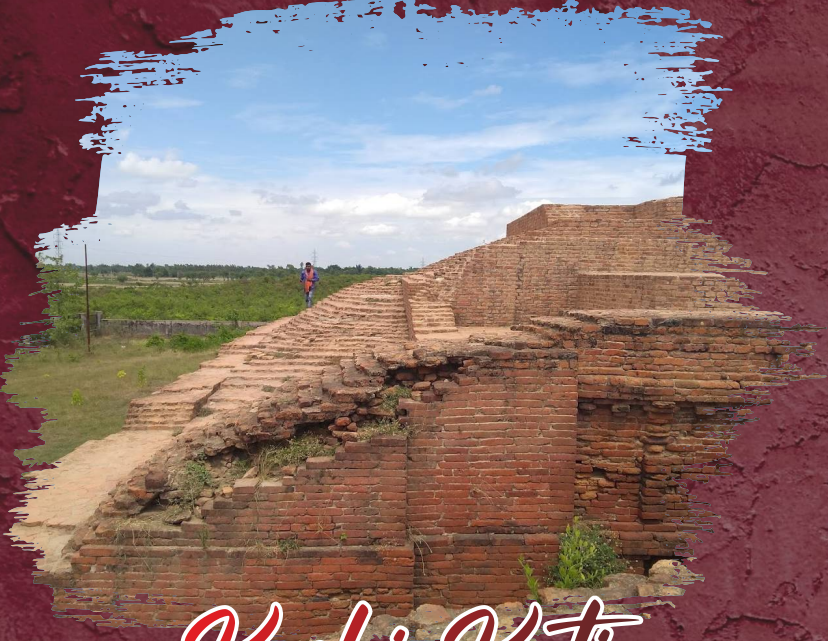
Mahamongkolchai Dhammaland

The Mahamongkol Chai Stupa is a striking golden monument near the Jetavana complex, built as a tribute to Lord Buddha's teachings. The Daen Mahamongkolchai World Peacefulness Foundation here offers a serene forest-like meditation retreat. Set amidst peaceful surroundings with a nearby water tank, it offers a serene space for reflection. Around 200 women from various countries live and work here, promoting education and humanitarian service.



Jetavana

Jetavana, is not only a sacred Buddhist site but also a symbol of mindful living. The eco-friendly lifestyle and sustainable practices followed here reflected deep respect for nature and all life forms. Even today, the serene environment and spiritual legacy of Jetavana inspire visitors to embrace biodiversity and cultivate compassion. Walking through its ancient grounds evokes a sense of harmony with both nature and self.



Kachi Kuti

Located just southeast of Pakki Kuti, Kachi Kuti is believed to be the site of Anathapindika's home—one of Lord Buddha's chief patrons. Excavations trace its origins to the Kushana period. During Lord Buddha's time, the house was often filled with monks from Jetavana, creating a sacred atmosphere of saffron robes and spiritual serenity. It's a must-visit for those seeking a glimpse into the daily life of early Buddhist devotees.



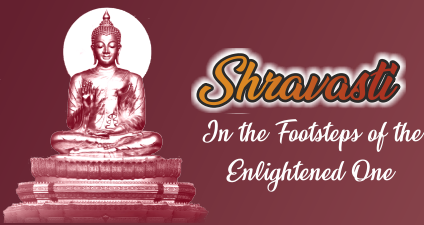
Suhaildev Wildlife Sanctuary

Nestled near the Indo-Nepal border and close to the Buddhist town of Shravasti, Suhaildev Wildlife Sanctuary is a vast natural haven rich in biodiversity. Spanning over 450 sq. km, the sanctuary is home to tigers, leopards, deer, and vibrant birdlife, along with scenic water bodies like Raziataal and Chittorgarh. It offers a unique glimpse into the life of the indigenous Tharu tribe and is a peaceful retreat for both nature lovers and those on the Buddhist circuit.



Orajhar

Orajhar, a Buddhist site situated on Bahraich-Balrampur road (on the left bank of Khajua, a tributary of Rapti), is one of the popular places to visit in Shravasti. It may be identified with the celebrated Purvama or Eastern Monastery, built by Vishakha as seen by Fa-Hien. Here, the excavation has revealed a three-fold cultural sequence, starting from Kushan period (1st centuryAD) followed by Gupta and medieval periods.

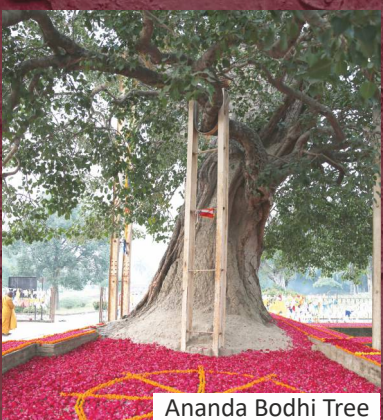


Lord Buddha's Journey to Heaven

Legend has it that following the famed **Twin Miracle** in Shravasti (Sāvatthī), Lord Buddha ascended to **Tavatimsa Heaven** to impart the teachings of the **Abhidhamma** to his deceased mother and other divine beings—a deeply compassionate act honored across Buddhist traditions. After spending the three-month rainy season there, he descended back to earth at **Sankissa**, gracefully stepping down the central jewel staircase crafted by Indra, accompanied by guardians from the heavens, and revealing the realms of gods, humans, and hell so that all beings could perceive the impact of karma.

Gandha Kuti

Gandha Kutī



Ananda Bodhi Tree

Ananda Bodhi Tree: One of the most auspicious spots in Jetavana is the Ananda Bodhi Tree. According to Buddhist history, one of the two Chief Disciples of Lord Buddha, Venerable Maha Mogallana brought the seed from the original sacred Maha Bodhi Tree in Bodhgaya, and was planted by Anathapindika under the direction of Venerable Ananda, who received permission from Lord Buddha. It miraculously grew into a big tree. In order to consecrate it, Lord Buddha spent one night under the tree, radiating loving-kindness and blessings. This Bodhi Tree became the place of devotion for all Buddhists around the world.

World Peace Bell

Vibhuti Nath Temple

Vibhuti Nath Temple

Devī Patan Temple

Devi Patan Temple

Koilabas: Koilabas in Jai Prabha Gram offers a lively glimpse into local life, serving as the village's cultural and social hub. Here, festivals, events, and community gatherings bring colour and energy, making it a perfect spot to experience the region's traditions and warm hospitality.

Buddha Purnima

Buddha Purnima



Kathina Robe Offering



Asalha Puja

The Buddhist Circuit in Uttar Pradesh offers a soulful journey through sacred stupas, ancient monasteries, and historic sites linked to Lord Buddha's life. From his enlightenment to his teachings across the Gangetic plains, each stop echoes with spiritual serenity and deep heritage. Tourists can immerse in the peaceful aura, age-old chants, and timeless wisdom that still linger in these lands. It's not just a trip, but an inner quest for peace and self-discovery.

Sankisa: Located approximately 345 kms from Shravasti, it is where Lord Buddha is believed to have descended from heaven after preaching to his mother. The Ashokan elephant pillar and ancient relics found here continue to fascinate spiritual seekers and historians alike.

Air: Nearest airport is in Lucknow, approx. 180 Km.
Rail: Nearest railway stn. is in Balrampur, approx. 17 Km.
Road: It is well connected by a network of roads to neighbouring cities. Travellers can opt for Volvo AC buses, UPSRTC services, or taxis for a smooth and comfortable journey by road.

Tourist Bungalow Campus, Balrampur Tel.: 05263-232456

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